

INTRO STATEMENT FOR A C-LEVEL EXECUTIVE INTERVIEW

I'm a senior enterprise architect and technology leader with extensive experience building digital asset platforms within regulated financial institutions. What I bring to this role is the ability to define & operationalize a digital asset strategy that is secure, scalable, production-ready and can support real financial products while meeting risk and regulatory requirements.

My experience spans designing production-grade digital asset platforms across private and public blockchain networks, ~~including tokenization frameworks and custody operating models~~, as well as architecting institutional crypto custody and ~~stablecoin~~ solutions that integrate seamlessly with core banking and payment systems.

In my recent role, I defined the architecture strategy and led the delivery of Northern Trust's digital asset platform. The focus was on building a flexible, reusable foundation that could support multiple asset classes—such as carbon credits, fixed income assets, and private equity funds—on a single platform, which significantly improved the speed at which new products could be launched.

A key part of that work was enabling delivery-versus-payment settlement by integrating the digital asset platform with traditional payment systems, ensuring that asset transfers and cash movements are coordinated within existing banking workflows.

I work closely with product, risk, security, and infrastructure teams to ensure these platforms are not only scalable, but also governed and operationally sound within a regulated environment.

I also serve as a technical advisor to executive leadership, guiding decisions on Cloud native services, blockchain protocol selection, MPC custody integration, interoperability models, and scalability strategy.

Beyond architecture, I focus on execution. I've led globally distributed teams to deliver complex platforms that improved operational efficiency and enabled new revenue opportunities, while maintaining the discipline required in financial services.

Overall, my focus is on helping organizations adopt digital assets in a way that is secure, scalable, and aligned with how banks actually operate. Given my experience across architecture strategy, custody, and payment integration, I believe this role aligns very closely with my background and where I can contribute immediately.

“Why You” Answer (Executive-Level)

I think what I bring that’s particularly relevant for this role is a **combination of experience and approach**.

First, I’ve had the opportunity to **design and deliver digital asset platforms in regulated financial environments**—not just at a conceptual level, but taking them from strategy through to production. That includes **building tokenization platforms, integrating custody models**, and ensuring these systems work within **existing banking infrastructure**, particularly around payments and settlement.

Second, I tend to **approach digital assets from a very practical, institutional perspective**. My focus is always on how these platforms can **support real financial products**, integrate with core systems, and operate within the governance and risk frameworks that banks require. That balance between innovation and control is something I’ve spent a lot of time working through.

And third, I **focus heavily on execution**. I’ve led globally distributed teams to deliver these platforms, working closely across product, infrastructure, and risk teams to ensure the solutions are not just well-designed, but actually adopted and scalable.

So overall, I believe the **combination of hands-on platform experience, understanding of how digital assets fit into traditional banking systems**, and the **ability to execute at scale** positions me well to contribute in this role.

“What interested you in this role, and how do you see yourself contributing here?”

What drew me to this role is the **opportunity** to work at the **intersection of digital assets and core banking infrastructure**, which is where I’ve spent a significant part of my recent experience.

What I find particularly compelling is the **focus on building institutional-grade capabilities**—whether that’s around custody, tokenization, or settlement—and doing so in a way that aligns with existing payment systems, regulatory expectations, and broader enterprise architecture. That’s an area where I’ve seen a real gap in the market, and also where I’ve been deeply involved.

In terms of how I see **myself contributing**, I think it comes down to **two areas**. **First, helping shape and execute a practical architecture strategy**—one that

allows the organization to move forward with digital asset initiatives while ensuring they are scalable, secure, and aligned with how the bank operates today.

And second, helping bridge across teams—product, infrastructure, risk, and engineering—to ensure that what gets designed is actually delivered and adopted. A lot of the value in this space comes from getting that alignment right, not just from the technology itself.

Overall, this role feels like a **strong alignment with both my experience and how I approach building platforms in regulated environments**, and I see a clear opportunity to contribute meaningfully.

“How do you think about balancing innovation with risk in digital assets?”

I generally think about this as **enabling innovation within a controlled framework**, rather than treating it as a tradeoff between the two.

In a **banking context**, innovation doesn't come from moving fast without constraints—it comes from **designing platforms that allow the business to move forward safely**. So my approach is to establish **strong guardrails upfront**—around custody, transaction controls, compliance, and integration with existing systems—so that **product teams can innovate** within those boundaries.

In practice, that often means **taking a phased approach**. You **start with use cases** and asset classes that are **well understood and easier to control**, and you build confidence in the platform and operating model before expanding into more complex areas.

A big part of my **focus is ensuring** that these platforms **align with core banking systems, payment processes, and governance frameworks**, so they behave like any other institutional system.

Ultimately, the **goal is to make innovation repeatable and scalable**—so you're not taking one-off risks, but building a foundation where new capabilities can be introduced in a controlled and sustainable way.

“What benefits can we derive when using AI with Digital Assets and crypto platforms”

I tend to think of **AI as a complementary capability** that can make digital asset platforms more efficient, more intelligent, and easier to operate at scale—rather than something that changes the core infrastructure.

There are a few areas where I see immediate value:

First is **operational efficiency and automation**. Digital asset platforms introduce new workflows around custody, settlement, and reconciliation. AI can help **automate exception handling, streamline operations, and reduce manual intervention**, which becomes important as volumes grow.

Second is **risk and compliance**. AI can be used to **monitor transaction patterns**, flag anomalies, and support areas like **AML or wallet screening**. Given the regulatory sensitivity around digital assets, this is an area where AI can add meaningful value when implemented with the right controls.

And third is **access to information and usability**. These platforms can be complex, and AI—particularly with **natural language interfaces**—can help internal users or clients **interact with data more intuitively**, whether that’s **querying transactions**, understanding positions, or navigating workflows.

Overall, the opportunity is to use AI to make digital asset platforms more operationally efficient, more transparent, and easier to use, rather than fundamentally changing how the underlying systems work.

How do you see digital assets evolving in banking over the next few years?

- **Shift from experimentation to production adoption**
Banks will move beyond pilots toward real, revenue-generating digital asset products integrated into core operations.
- **Tokenization of traditional financial instruments**
Increased focus on tokenizing assets like money market funds, bonds, and private markets to improve efficiency and access.
- **Integration with existing financial infrastructure**
Digital assets will increasingly connect with custody, payments, and settlement systems rather than operate as standalone platforms.

- **Greater emphasis on custody and risk controls**
Institutional-grade custody, key management, and regulatory compliance will become foundational to adoption.
- **Emergence of stablecoins for payments and liquidity**
Stablecoins will play a larger role in settlement, treasury, and cross-border payments.
- **Interoperability and standardization**
Movement toward common standards and interoperability across platforms and networks to enable broader ecosystem participation.

Overall, the focus will shift from the technology itself to how digital assets improve financial products and market infrastructure.

How do you balance innovation with risk, especially in digital assets?

- **Establish guardrails upfront**
Define clear controls around custody, transaction authorization, compliance, and data governance before enabling innovation.
- **Innovate within a controlled framework**
Enable teams to move quickly, but within well-defined architectural and risk boundaries.
- **Adopt a phased approach**
Start with lower-risk use cases and expand as the platform, controls, and operating model mature.
- **Integrate with existing systems**
Ensure alignment with core banking, payments, and reporting workflows to avoid operational and regulatory gaps.
- **Focus on repeatable, scalable patterns**
Build platform capabilities that allow innovation to scale without introducing one-off risks.
- **Maintain strong governance and oversight**
Continuous monitoring, auditability, and collaboration with risk and compliance teams are essential.

The goal is not to slow innovation, but to make it sustainable and scalable within a regulated environment.

Example Achievement (Product-Manager Friendly Version)

One of the projects I'm most proud of was **leading the architecture and delivery** of a **digital asset platform** designed to help the bank **launch tokenized financial** products in a **controlled, enterprise-grade environment**.

The Bank wanted to explore how **tokenization could create new products** while still fitting within **existing banking operations and regulatory** expectations. My role was to design the underlying platform and guide the engineering teams to build something **flexible enough to support multiple asset types**, rather than creating a one-off solution for a single product.

We built the platform on a **private blockchain infrastructure** and deliberately **designed it to be blockchain-agnostic** so the bank wouldn't be locked into a single technology choice. Just as important, we **integrated it with traditional financial messaging systems such as SWIFT** so that tokenized transactions could still work within existing settlement and payment rails.

From a **product perspective**, the key outcome was that the **platform enabled tokenization of multiple asset classes**—such as carbon credits, fixed income instruments, private equity and MMF — on the **same infrastructure**. That significantly reduced the time and effort required to launch new products **because the core capabilities**—token issuance, lifecycle management, custody and delivery-versus-payment settlement—were **already built into the platform**.

The platform is now **live in production and supporting clients**, which was particularly **rewarding** because it **demonstrated that blockchain** technology can **operate reliably** within a traditional financial institution when it's **designed with enterprise governance, security, and operational processes** in mind.

For me, the **most satisfying part of that achievement** was working closely with **product, operations, and compliance teams** to translate a fairly **abstract concept—tokenization**—into a **platform** that actually enabled new financial products while fitting seamlessly into the bank's existing ecosystem.

How would you evaluate whether a financial product should be tokenized?

When evaluating whether a financial product should be tokenized, I usually start by looking at the underlying business problem rather than the technology itself. Tokenization tends to create the most value in areas where there are inefficiencies in asset transfer, settlement, ownership tracking, or access to markets.

For example, in the digital asset platform I helped build, we focused on asset classes like Carbon credits & private equity. These were good candidates because they often involve complex ownership records, manual reconciliation processes, and limited liquidity. Tokenization allowed us to represent those assets digitally while improving transparency, automating parts of the lifecycle through smart contracts, and enabling more efficient settlement models.

The second dimension I evaluate is how well the tokenized asset can integrate into existing financial infrastructure. Institutions still rely heavily on traditional systems—payments, custody, compliance reporting—so it's important that the platform connects cleanly with those ecosystems.

Finally, I look at operational and regulatory considerations. For financial institutions, the success of a tokenized product depends heavily on governance, custody models, and compliance controls. If those elements can be implemented in a secure and auditable way, then tokenization can move from being an experiment to something that can support real financial products.

Ultimately, my approach is to treat tokenization as a platform capability that enables better financial products, not as the product itself.